



City Council September 28, 2022

Meeting Metadata	Details
Video Recording	https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=AOUO2vYHV84
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Target Category	muncie_city

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Comprehensive Municipal Meeting Summary

2. Meeting Identification & Attendance

- **Call to Order & Spoken Details:** Presiding officer called the September 28th meeting of the Common Council to order [00:00:15](#), noting that it is the first scheduled meeting to review the proposed 2023 municipal budget [00:01:06](#). The presiding officer clarified that these sessions are held as special meetings of the council rather than finance committee meetings to allow for official action and efficiency [00:01:53](#).
- **Attendance:**
 - **Present:** Mr. Ingram, Mr. Garrett, Mr. Overby, Mr. Dishman, Mr. Polk, Mr. Clark, Miss Selby, Mr. Robbins (8 members present) [[00:04:48](#)<U+2013>[01:03](#)].
 - **Absent:** (Mr. Green was called during roll call with no recorded response) [00:00:53](#).
 - **Presiding Officer:** Noted as the Council President/Presiding Officer.

3. Preliminary & Procedural Business

- **Ceremonial Openings:** The meeting opened with the Pledge of Allegiance led by Dan Gibson [00:00:18](#).
- **Approval of Minutes:** *Not applicable/Not addressed in this transcript segment.*

4. Substantive Business & Board Action

(Special budget review meetings focusing on departmental budget presentations for the 2023 municipal budget)

4.1. Finance Division & Controller Budget Review

- **Item Identifier & Title:** [00:02:44](#) Finance Division & Controller 2023 Budget Review
- **Sponsor / Presenter:** Craig (Controller / City Attorney) [00:02:44](#)
- **Deliberation Summary:** Controller confirmed that revenues are certified true and accurate by Ryan Burke (Department of Local Government Finance) and that the budget was prepared in accordance with Indiana Code 36-4-7-6 and local ordinances [00:02:56](#). The budget remains the exact same as the previous year, with a mandated 2% payroll increase reflecting the AFSCME contract [00:03:41](#).
- **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
- **Action & Vote Disposition:** Informational presentation; no formal vote taken.

4.2. Mayor<U+2019>s Office Budget Review

- **Item Identifier & Title:** [00:05:37](#) Mayor<U+2019>s Office 2023 Budget Review
- **Sponsor / Presenter:** The Mayor [00:05:48](#)
- **Deliberation Summary:** The Mayor reported a small decrease in a part-time line item (dropping just under \$5,000), with overall spending remaining flat aside from the standard 2% salary increases [00:06:00](#). The presiding officer noted that the proposed 2023 budget would be uploaded to the city council website within a day or two [00:06:40](#).
- **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
- **Action & Vote Disposition:** Informational presentation; no formal vote taken.

4.3. City Attorney Budget Review

- **Item Identifier & Title:** [00:07:13](#) City Attorney 2023 Budget Review
- **Sponsor / Presenter:** Craig (City Attorney) [00:07:27](#)
- **Deliberation Summary:** The City Attorney noted that the budget contains a single line item for the retainer fee, which has not increased [00:07:31](#). Additional charges for legal work go directly to the specific departments utilizing the services [00:07:57](#).
- **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
- **Action & Vote Disposition:** Informational presentation; no formal vote taken.

4.4. Information Technology (IT) Department Budget Review

- **Item Identifier & Title:** [00:08:14](#) IT Department 2023 Budget Review
- **Sponsor / Presenter:** IT Department Representative [00:08:21](#)

- **Deliberation Summary:** The IT budget is identical to the 2022 budget down to the penny [00:08:27](#). Discussion covered software upgrades, with the department clarifying that enterprise-wide solutions (such as payroll/financial applications) are handled through central IT maintenance, while larger departments like police and fire manage their own application upgrades [00:08:52](#).
- **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
- **Action & Vote Disposition:** Informational presentation; no formal vote taken.

4.5. Board of Works Budget Review

- **Item Identifier & Title:** [00:09:44](#) Board of Works 2023 Budget Review
- **Sponsor / Presenter:** Craig (representing Board of Works) [00:09:44](#)
- **Deliberation Summary:** The Board of Works budget remains flat except for the 9/11 call center (communication center) contribution, which increased from \$900,000 to \$1,000,000 [00:09:58](#). Council and staff discussed bringing forward an updated local interlocal agreement regarding the center by November [00:10:28](#). Council also questioned an unemployment line item reduced to zero, which staff explained was achieved by shifting available funds to other lines [00:11:17](#).
- **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
- **Action & Vote Disposition:** Informational presentation; no formal vote taken.

4.6. Building Commissioner Budget Review

- **Item Identifier & Title:** [00:12:00](#) Building Commissioner 2023 Budget Review
- **Sponsor / Presenter:** Craig (speaking on behalf of Building Commissioner Steve Shepherd) [00:12:10](#)
- **Deliberation Summary:** Budget includes the 2% salary increase alongside an approximate 20% increase (\$942) in gas and oil/fuel charges to account for inflation [00:12:35](#). Councilman Ingram clarified staffing levels for the zoning and structural inspector positions [00:13:41](#).
- **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
- **Action & Vote Disposition:** Informational presentation; no formal vote taken.

4.7. Parks Department Budget Review

- **Item Identifier & Title:** [00:14:28](#) Parks Department 2023 Budget Review
- **Sponsor / Presenter:** Mr. Malone (Parks Department) [00:14:47](#)
- **Deliberation Summary:** The Parks Department plans to operate within its 2022 funding levels for 2023 without adding new parks [00:14:54](#). Council and the department discussed grant writing efforts by Shannon Powers [00:15:51](#), general operational expenses under services and charges [00:16:21](#), and the potential need to increase part-time/seasonal help allocations to address maintenance issues (such as high grass and new splash pads) [00:17:04](#). *(Note: Prairie Creek's budget was noted as self-sufficient and*

approved separately through the parks board; director Dustin Clark was acknowledged for preparing for the upcoming Ironman weekend) 00:18:25.

- **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
- **Action & Vote Disposition:** Informational presentation; no formal vote taken.

4.8. Communications / Channel 60 Budget Review

- **Item Identifier & Title:** 00:20:01 Communications / Channel 60 2023 Budget Review
- **Sponsor / Presenter:** Michelle Owen (Director of Communications) 00:20:01
- **Deliberation Summary:** The council congratulated Ms. Owen on competing in and finishing a full Ironman race in Maryland 00:20:09. Line items remain identical to the previous year aside from the standard 2% salary increase 00:20:51. Council members inquired about and praised her expanded duties managing social media, press releases, media relations, and citizen concerns 00:21:39.
- **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
- **Action & Vote Disposition:** Informational presentation; no formal vote taken.

5. Open Public Comment / Citizen Forum

- 00:24:18 **Bob Rick Yinser** (Former newsman and author) addressed the council regarding broader spending concerns in the budget 00:24:41. He questioned whether property tax increases across multiple districts are being compounded, expressed concern over EDIT spending (specifically referencing the purchase and demolition of the YMCA), and questioned the distribution of municipal bonuses versus taxpayer refunds/stimulus funds 00:24:27. He concluded by urging fiscal restraint and caution regarding potential tax increases 00:25:43.

6. Administrative Updates & Adjournment

- **Staff / Board Announcements:**
 - The presiding officer announced that the next regular meeting will be held on Monday, October 2nd 00:26:20.
 - The next special budget meeting will take place on **Wednesday, October 5th** (misstated verbally as October 3rd/5th) to review the street department, police department, fire department, EMS, merit commissions, and animal shelter 00:26:28.
- **Adjournment:** A motion to adjourn was made by Robbie Ingram and seconded by Mr. Overby 00:26:51. Approved by Voice Vote 00:27:03.